
WORKSHEET

Brand Messaging Worksheet

Work through what the business does, who it serves, why it matters, what makes it different, and how that message should be communicated.

Pulse Analytics Group LLC

Free Resources Library

Good messaging answers the questions customers are already asking.

What do you actually do? Who is it for? Why should someone care? What is different about your approach? What evidence supports those statements? This worksheet is designed to force clear answers before those messages are spread across a website, social profiles, proposals, and campaigns.

Do not try to make every answer sound clever. Clear beats clever when the reader is deciding whether to keep reading.

Worksheet record

Business / brand	_____
Person completing worksheet	_____
Date	_____
Primary market / audience	_____
Main offer being clarified	_____

1. Start with the business

Write the plain-language version first. Marketing copy comes later.

What do we sell or provide?	
Who is it primarily for?	
What problem or job does it address?	
What happens after a customer says yes?	
What does the customer receive?	
What do we deliberately NOT provide?	

2. Audience clarity

The audience description should be specific enough to change what you say, show, or emphasize.

Audience segment	Situation / need	What they already know	What they need to understand

3. Customer problem and outcome

Separate the customer's situation from the solution you sell.

Prompt	Working answer
What is the customer trying to accomplish?	
What gets in the way?	
What does the current situation cost in time, money, effort, risk, or attention?	
What changes when the problem is handled well?	
What would a customer use to judge whether the result was useful?	

4. Value proposition

Draft three versions. The first can be plain. The second can be customer-facing. The third can be short enough for a profile or header.

Version	Draft
Plain-language sentence	
Customer-facing version	
Short version	

5. What makes the offer different?

Do not list adjectives such as “better,” “premier,” or “innovative” unless you can explain what those words mean in observable terms.

Possible differentiator	What is actually different?	Evidence / proof	Customer relevance

6. Proof points

Record evidence that can support the message. If a statement cannot be supported, weaken it, qualify it, or remove it.

Claim we may make	Evidence	Source / date	Limitations

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7. Message hierarchy

Decide what the reader needs to understand first, second, and third. Not every message belongs at the top of the page.

Level	Message	Where it belongs	Evidence / note
1. Core			
2. Supporting			
3. Proof			
4. Detail			

8. Voice and tone rules

Keep	Avoid	Example

9. Channel translation

Keep the underlying message consistent while adapting the length, format, and call to action to the channel.

Channel	Core message	Supporting point	CTA	Proof / asset
Website homepage				
Service/product page				
Social profile				
Email				
Proposal / sales deck				
Ad				

10. Message stress test

- ☐ Can someone understand what we do without knowing our industry jargon?
- ☐ Would a customer know who this is for?
- ☐ Does the message explain a useful outcome or only describe a feature?
- ☐ Could a reasonable person interpret the message as a guarantee?
- ☐ Can we point to evidence for the important claims?
- ☐ Does the message still make sense when the reader sees it without the rest of the campaign?
- ☐ What part of the message would we be comfortable having a skeptical customer question?

Final message set

Write the version you would actually put into use after completing the worksheet.

Current references

- FTC Advertising and Marketing Basics: <https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/advertising-marketing>
- Google Search - Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content:
<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/creating-helpful-content>